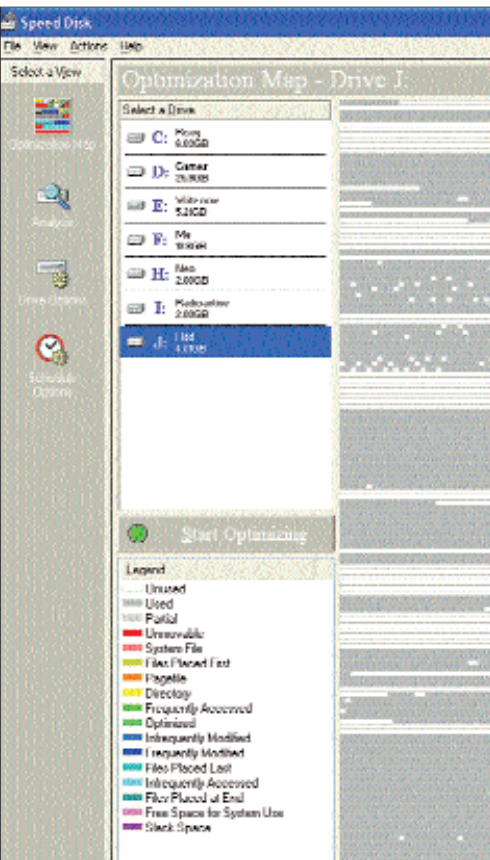


scans the hard disk for any errors. Click on it to start the DiskFixer Wizard that will list all the drives available for scanning. Select the drives you want to scan, and at the bottom of the window, click on the Settings tab. Select all the tests and choose Duplicate under the Crosslinks option, and select Delete under the 'Lost Clusters' option. Select all the scans under Surface Scan, and click OK. Back in the main wizard screen, select 'Automatically fix errors without asking me', 'Save Undo Information' and 'Scan disk surface for read errors'—which helps by doing a more thorough physical test of your hard disk. this will take some time. Click Next to see the screen where the fixer shows a complete map of your hard disk while checking it. As the disk surface scan has been selected, the time taken will depend on your PC's configuration.

Speed Disk: Defragging using Speed Disk in Norton is quite easy. In Windows 98, start Speed Disk by going to **Start > Norton SystemWorks > Norton Utilities > Optimize Performance > Norton Speed Disk**. The first dialog box shows you a list of available drives. Select the drive which you want to



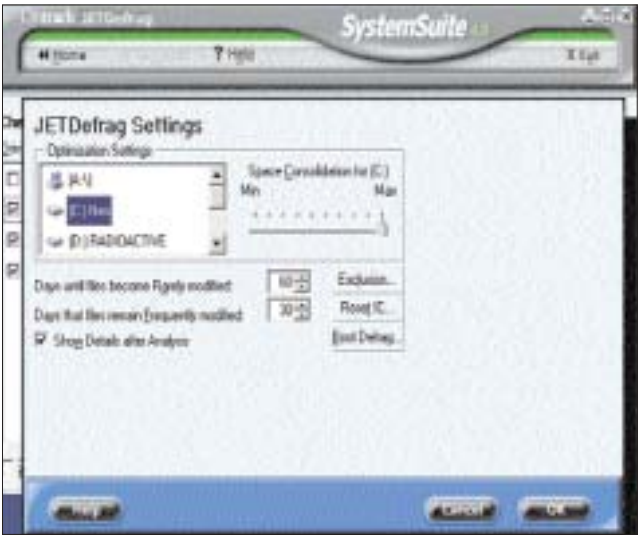
Sort files according to how often they are accessed, when defragmenting using Norton Speed disk

defragment, and click on Settings. Click on 'Optimize swap file' to defrag the swap file, if it is fragmented. You can also arrange files by the date they were created, accessed, used or file size. These options should be selected only if you know which files go where. You can also select specific files and files with wildcard characters. This results in a customised and efficient defragmentation process. You can use wildcards to specify the files Windows uses, and they will be arranged in the starting portion of the drive. This makes them accessible faster.

For Windows XP, there are no direct options for setting such criteria, but you can manually add the file-names you want by clicking on Drive Options. In the tabs

named Files First, File Last, Files at End and Unmovable Files, you can add the file-names with wildcards so as to place them accordingly. Clicking on Add Wildcard opens up a file where you can enter wildcard characters in filenames, or directly file extensions such as .exe, .dll, .hlp, etc. Under Add File, an Open File dialog opens asking for files to be added—you can select multiple files at once. Finally click OK and then Start, to begin defragmenting. You can do the same for other partitions as well, such as your Games partition, where you need maximum performance.

Ontrack JETDefrag: Ontrack advises you to use DiskFixer before using JETDefrag. This is to ensure that no errors occur during the defragmentation process. Click on OK, and select the drives you want to defrag. Select Analyze Drive at the bottom-left of the window to analyse the level of fragmentation of your drives. Click on Settings, and move the Space Consolidation slider to the Maximum end



Ontrack JETDefrag lets you sort files according to the minimum and maximum number of days since they were accessed

Info Never stop the defragmentation process once started. Even if the progress bar stops, do not shut down the computer. If there is no activity for 20 minutes, switch off the PC, but remember, files lost while doing this are irrecoverable.

of the slider. This will eliminate the slack space, and pack the files more tightly ensuring maximum defragmentation. Under 'Days until files become Rarely modified:' you can specify which least accessed

files will go—if you specify the number of days as 60, then the files not modified for 60 days will be considered as rarely used or modified—the higher the number of days, the more files will be placed at the end of the drive. In the option 'Days the files remain Frequently modified:', set the number of days specifying files that are frequently modified. These files will be placed at the start position

of the drive so as to hasten access to them. So the lower the number, the more recent files will be placed at the beginning of the drive. Click OK, and then click Next. In the Warning dialog box, click OK to start the defragmentation process. Do not open, or run anything while it is running. After it's over, press Done and close the main window. Shut down Windows, and leave it off to cool down from the heat produced by intense hard disk activity.

Always remember to perform these actions, no matter what utility you choose, as regularly as possible. Doing this every 10 to 15 days will prolong the life of your hard drive, and also make a noticeable difference in speeds and access times for your applications and games.

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